

KARAN CHAWLA DORA

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Bachelor of Applied Science — Engineering Science (cGPA: **3.95/4.0**)

Toronto, ON

2025 – 2030

Research Interests: control systems, robot autonomy, state estimation

EXPERIENCE

SAE AutoDrive - Toronto Autonomous Vehicle Team (aUToronto) [🔗](#)

Sep. 2025 – Present

State Estimation Developer

Toronto, ON

- Developed a lane localization pipeline for autonomous vehicle pose accuracy during GPS dropouts.
- Implemented an Iterated Extended Kalman Filter IEKF processing 100+ lane observations per 5 meters.
- Created ROS2 bag analysis and CI validation workflows, evaluating performance across vehicle tests.

FIRST Robotics Competition [🔗](#)

Jul. 2021 – Jun. 2025

Robotics Team Captain & Software Development Lead

Ottawa, ON

- Directed a 90+ member cross-functional Scrum team through design, manufacturing, and software cycles, securing World Championship qualification and 2x Provincial Finalist finishes.
- Engineered robust autonomous routines in C++ by integrating Computer Vision (AprilTags), wheel odometry, and trajectory generation paths, resulting in a threefold increase in autonomous scoring efficiency.
- Improved robot precision by tuning feedforward and PID feedback control systems for mechanism control.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Researcher @ Autonomous Space Robotics Lab (ASRL) [🔗](#) | Supervisor: **Tim Barfoot**

May 2026 – Present

- Integrated a mesh radio network for a multi-robot fleet improving the distance of connectivity by over 100x.
- Created a ROS2 node to publish battery health and telemetry data to evaluate mesh radio network status.

Bruce Lab — University of Ottawa [🔗](#) | Research Assistant

Aug. 2024

- Improved transient time by 80% and steady-state error by 40% by implementing C++ PID controllers for platinum-nickel electrodeposition current and voltage stabilization.
- Reduced experimental cycles by 33% by architecting a Python GUI/interface for automated trial execution, sensor logging, and data curation.
- Expanded operating voltage range by 5x by refining an Arduino-based potentiostat circuit and control workflow.

Canadian Robotics and Artificial Intelligence Ethics Design Lab [🔗](#) | Robotics Research

Aug. 2024

- Accelerated project timeline by 50% by characterizing DJI Robomaster S1 behavior in a simulated robotics environment.
- Achieved 1-second target tracking by implementing Python computer vision and machine learning models.

PROJECTS

Reinforcement Learning Q-Learning Trainer Simulator [🔗](#) | Python, FastAPI, NumPy, JavaScript

June 2026

- Architected a full-stack tabular Q-learning app with custom maps, real-time WebSocket training viz, hyperparameter lab, and model validation suite.
- Deployed RL training dashboard to Fly.io with session isolation and Docker; added pytest regressions for layout parsing, reachability, and evaluation checks.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C, C++, Bash, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS

Robotics & Control: ROS, state estimation, sensor fusion, PID control, odometry, computer vision, networking

Tools & Libraries: Linux, CI/CD, Git, Arduino, NumPy, pandas, Matplotlib, Next.js